

H1 FY2026 Trade Promotion Effectiveness & Post-Event Analysis

Reading incrementality, ROI and forward-buy leakage across the Q1 event book

Document type Trade promotion post-event analysis (PEA)

Period H1 FY2026 (Q1 event detail)

Owner Revenue Growth Mgmt; Trade Finance

Prepared June 2026

Events analysed (Q1 FY26)	43 events
Trade spend	\$11.6M
Modelled incremental revenue	\$10.9M
Average lift / incrementality index	14.3% lift · 0.52 index
Headline call	Rationalise low-incrementality Crunchwell events; shift to displays

Executive summary

Across 43 Q1 FY2026 trade events, Acme spent \$11.6M to drive \$10.9M of modelled incremental revenue — an average lift of 14.3% at a portfolio incrementality index of 0.52. An index of 0.52 means roughly half of promoted volume would have sold anyway; the trade dollar is under-working. The pattern is consistent with the FY25 read: Crunchwell absorbs the majority of trade spend at a deep discount but returns middling incrementality, while display-led mechanics and the leaner ProteinPeak events return far more per dollar. The recommendation is to rationalise the low-incrementality Crunchwell price events and shift the mix toward displays.

- **Portfolio incrementality is 0.52** — below a 1.0 breakeven read; about half of promoted volume is subsidised base.
- **Crunchwell** takes ~\$8.5M of the \$11.6M spend (73%) at a 0.53 index — the biggest efficiency opportunity in the book.
- **Mechanic matters more than depth:** display-led events (Display + sample, Display only) return 0.66–0.72 index; flat price-off cuts (\$0.40–\$0.50 off) return 0.38–0.41 and include the value-destroying cluster.
- **Forward-buy / value destruction** is real — three Mountain-West price events returned *negative* incrementality (index –0.15 to –0.21). See the RGM read, Report 17.

1 · PEA scorecard

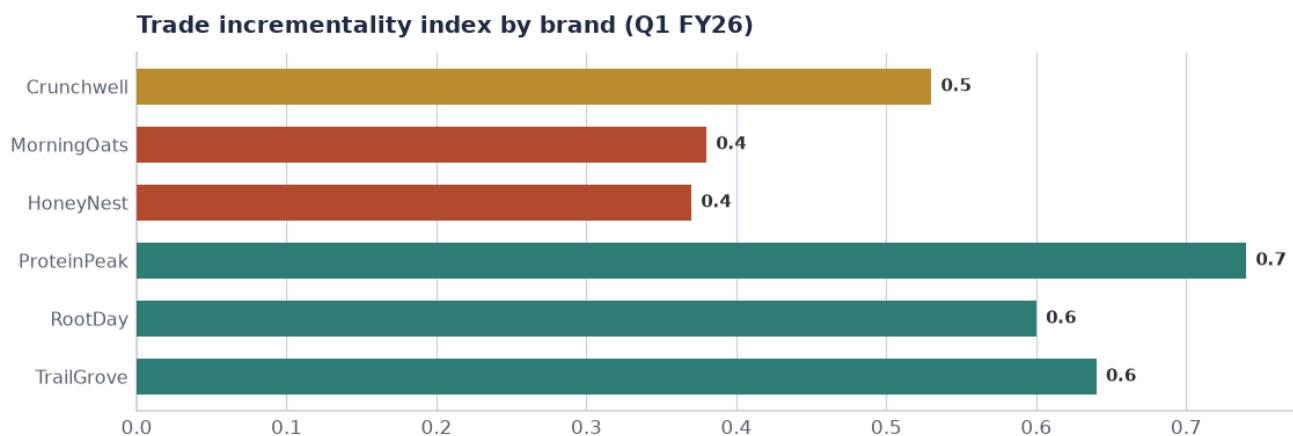
EVENTS	SPEND	INCREMENTAL	INCR. INDEX
43	\$11.6M	\$10.9M	0.52
Q1 FY26	trade investment	modelled	≈ half is base

Method. Post-event analysis compares promoted-period sales to a modelled base to isolate incremental units, then nets the incremental gross margin against event spend. The incrementality index is incremental volume ÷ total promoted volume; an index near 1.0 means the promotion sold genuinely new volume, while a low index means most promoted units were subsidised base. PEA ROI = (incremental gross margin – spend) ÷ spend.

2 · Incrementality by brand

Brand	Events	Spend	Incremental	Avg lift	Incr. index
Crunchwell	28	\$8.5M	\$8.1M	15.4%	0.53
MorningOats	4	\$0.9M	\$0.7M	14.3%	0.38
HoneyNest	4	\$0.9M	\$0.6M	11.3%	0.37
ProteinPeak	3	\$0.8M	\$1.1M	12.3%	0.74
RootDay	2	\$0.3M	\$0.3M	12.0%	0.60
TrailGrove	2	\$0.2M	\$0.3M	11.5%	0.64
Total	43	\$11.6M	\$10.9M	14.3%	0.52

Source: seed_trade_promo_events_q1_2026.



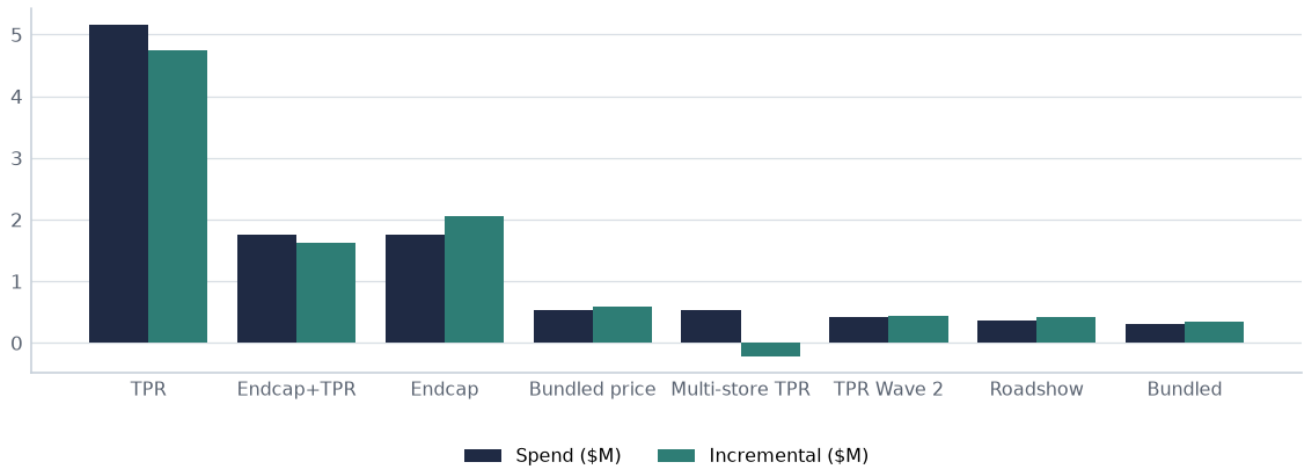
ProteinPeak (0.74) and TrailGrove (0.64) work hard; Crunchwell (0.53) absorbs 73% of spend at a middling index; HoneyNest (0.37) and MorningOats (0.38) drag.

Crunchwell absorbs ~\$8.5M of the \$11.6M book (73% of spend) at a 0.53 index. That is the efficiency prize: even a modest lift in Crunchwell's index moves the whole portfolio. ProteinPeak, by contrast, spends lean (\$0.82M) and returns a 0.74 index — the lean, display-and-sample launch model is working.

3 · What works — mechanic & event type

Grouping by event type shows the lever is *mechanic*, not depth. Display-led events (Endcap, roadshow, display + sample) return the highest incrementality; flat price-off TPRs return the least and contain every value-destroying event in the book. Spend, however, is concentrated in exactly the wrong place — TPR price cuts carry the most dollars.

Spend vs incremental revenue by event type (\$M)



Plain TPR carries the most spend but returns near-parity; Endcap (display) returns more incremental than it costs. Multi-store TPR is net-negative.

Source: seed_trade_promo_events_q1_2026, event types with ≥ \$0.3M spend.

3.1 · Display-led vs price-led

Mechanic family	Spend	Avg incr. index
Other	\$0.8M	0.62
Display-led	\$3.9M	0.59
Price-led (TPR)	\$6.9M	0.47

Source: seed_trade_promo_events_q1_2026, grouped by mechanic family.

4 · Best & worst events

4.1 · Top 3 events by incrementality

Event	Brand	Retailer	Mechanic	Spend \$K	Incr \$K	Index
TPE-Q1-011	Crunchwell	Multi-retailer-LA	\$0.55 off 14oz	280	612	1.10
TPE-Q1-022	ProteinPeak	Whole Foods	Display + sample	280	390	0.78
TPE-Q1-034	ProteinPeak	Sprouts	Display + sample	180	260	0.74

4.2 · Bottom 3 events — value-destroying

Event	Brand	Retailer	Mechanic	Spend \$K	Incr \$K	Index
TPE-Q1-018	Crunchwell	Mountain-West-Multi	\$0.50 off	540	-220	-0.21
TPE-Q1-019	HoneyNest	Mountain-West-Multi	\$0.40 off	180	-72	-0.18
TPE-Q1-020	MorningOats	Mountain-West-Multi	\$0.50 off + display	210	-92	-0.15

Source: seed_trade_promo_events_q1_2026, ranked by modelled incrementality index.

Forward-buy & the Mountain-West cluster

The three worst events are all flat price-off cuts run through a Mountain-West multi-store banner — they returned negative incremental revenue (index –0.15 to –0.21). This is classic forward-buy leakage: the discount pulled base volume forward and subsidised units the shopper would have bought at full price. The LA anchor event (TPE-Q1-011, \$0.55-off Crunchwell) is the counter-example — a 1.10 index and ~1.1 pts of share recovery. Reallocate away from the cluster; protect the LA anchor.

5 · FY25 context — Crunchwell is over-invested

The Q1 read is not new; it is the FY25 pattern repeating. In FY25 Crunchwell absorbed \$92.4M of ~\$147M total trade spend at a 25.6% depth of gross — roughly a quarter of gross revenue given back — for only a 0.57 incrementality index. The flagship is over-invested in deep price promotion that largely subsidises base volume, while the growth engine (ProteinPeak, 12.9% trade rate) is deliberately lean. Rebalancing the trade book toward high-incrementality mechanics is the single largest RGM lever (see the RGM read, Report 17).

5.1 · FY25 trade spend, depth & incrementality by brand

Brand	Trade spend	Weighted depth	Incr. index
Crunchwell	\$92.4M	27.3%	0.59
HoneyNest	\$21.7M	24.4%	0.51
TrailGrove	\$10.8M	13.7%	0.52
MorningOats	\$10.2M	18.0%	0.58
ProteinPeak	\$6.9M	11.9%	0.45
RootDay	\$4.7M	9.5%	0.42

Source: seed_trade_spend_fy25 (headline Crunchwell 25.6% depth / 0.57 index per FACTS).

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Rationalise the low-incrementality Crunchwell price events; cap flat price-off depth and retire the Mountain-West value-destroying cluster.	Revenue Growth Mgmt	H2 planning
2	Shift the mix toward display-led mechanics (Endcap, display + sample) that return 0.66–0.72 index vs 0.38–0.41 for flat price-off.	Trade Finance / RGM	H2
3	Protect and scale the LA anchor model (TPE-Q1-011, 1.10 index) as the template for share-recovery trade.	Marcus Boudreaux	Q3

#	Action	Owner	When
4	Instrument forward-buy detection in the PEA model so value-destroying events are flagged in-flight, not in the post-mortem.	Trade Finance	H2